

# Matthew Beardwell

Watford, Hertfordshire · [mbeardwell.com](https://mbeardwell.com) · [contact@mbeardwell.com](mailto:contact@mbeardwell.com) · [LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · [TryHackMe](#)

## Professional Summary

SOC Analyst Trainee with hands-on cybersecurity experience and a First-Class BSc (Hons) in Computer Science. Skilled in OSINT investigation and threat profiling, now applying these skills toward SOC and threat intel workflows. Ranked in the top 2% globally on TryHackMe (115 completed rooms, 17 badges).

Currently preparing for CompTIA Security+ to strengthen knowledge in alert triage and open-source threat research to support SOC and risk operations.

## Technical Skills

- **Security and Threat Detection:** SIEM (Splunk), Sysmon, Windows Logs, OSINT
- **Scripting and Programming:** Python, Bash, PowerShell, C, ARM ASM
- **Systems Admin:** Group Policy, Linux Hardening, Virtualisation
- **Incident Response:** Wireshark, TCP/IP, Firewalls
- **Threat Intelligence:** OSINT tooling, actor profiling, digital footprint resolution

## Cybersecurity Projects

### ActiveReconLite · Python Port Scanner

FEB 2025 – MAR 2025

Built a Python-based TCP connect port scanner using multiprocessing. Scanned 65k ports in 5s (vs Nmap's 5m). It validates user input, grabs banners, and writes results to a file. Demonstrates automation, socket programming, and parallel scanning.

[github.com/mbeardwell/active-recon-lite](https://github.com/mbeardwell/active-recon-lite)

### Location and Identity Resolution from Minimal Public Signals · OSINT Case Study

APR 2025

Tracked real-world identity from anonymised YouTube uploads using public data. Shows attacker thinking, threat profiling, and privacy risk awareness. Demonstrates threat intelligence process fundamentals: collection, enrichment, analysis, and attribution based on minimal public indicators.

[github.com/mbeardwell/osint-i3-case-study](https://github.com/mbeardwell/osint-i3-case-study)

### UK HUMINT OSINT Toolkit

JUN 2025

Curation of UK-only, legal person-focused OSINT resources for investigative use. Supports human profiling, exposure tracking, and background validation tasks.

[github.com/mbeardwell/osint-humint-toolkit](https://github.com/mbeardwell/osint-humint-toolkit)

### Faster Dynamically Instrumented Programs · Bachelor's Thesis

OCT 2022 – MAY 2023

Built a runtime patching tool on ARM Linux to redirect processor instructions in memory. Mirrors techniques used in evasive malware – useful for SOC detection and threat hunting.

[github.com/mbeardwell/arm-fp-emu](https://github.com/mbeardwell/arm-fp-emu)

## Professional Experience

*Building expertise during ongoing health recovery. Not currently available for roles. Open to future opportunities.*

### SOC Training and Labs · TryHackMe (Self-Led Learning)

FEB 2022 – PRESENT

Developed hands-on expertise in SIEM and security automation through 115 cybersecurity labs (Top 2% globally). Applied log analysis, detection logic, and SOC tooling in simulation labs.

### Private Tutor · Freelance

SEP 2016 – NOV 2019

Supported children with pre-GCSE homework, primarily in maths; adapted explanations to varying ability levels in informal settings.

### Research and Documentation Intern · Indo UK Institute of Health

JUN 2017 – AUG 2017

Conducted market research on employee benefits and strategic partnerships, providing executives with key insights. Edited and reformatted high-level strategic documents that shaped discussions on a billion-pound health-care initiative.

## Education and Certifications

**BSc (Hons) CS** · King's College London

First-Class

SEP 2018 – JUL 2023

**A-Levels** · King's Maths School

A\* A\* A\* A\*

SEP 2016 – JUL 2018

### Certifications

CompTIA

Security+

(IN PROGRESS)

TryHackMe

Intro to Cyber Security

FEB 2024

Security Blue Team

Intro to OSINT

JUN 2025

TryHackMe

Pre-Security

APR 2022

Prince's Trust

TEAM (12-week programme incl. First Aid)

JAN 2024 – APR 2024